

FISHKO — Stage 2 Customer Validation & Growth Plan

Build the Local Customer Base • Prove Repeat Orders • Then Scale

Stage 2 objective: prove that local customers will repeatedly pay FISHKO for fresh fish, convenience, fair pricing, hygiene and reliable morning delivery.

1. The Customer Problem

The hypothesis is that many customers dislike the process of buying fish: preparing to go out, travelling, paying transport, searching for the right fish, bargaining, carrying the fish home and cleaning it. FISHKO removes most of this friction by bringing properly handled fish to the customer's home.

Important: ■50–■100 travel cost and 1–2 hours saved are hypotheses until measured with real customers.

2. Target Customer

Start within a **2–3 km radius**: middle-class families, working couples, busy homemakers, elderly customers, people without convenient transport, apartment residents and customers who already buy fish regularly. The ideal repeat customer is someone who can order approximately **■250–■500** several times per month.

3. Validate Before Advertising

Interview 20–30 potential customers and record: purchase frequency, usual shop/market, normal spend, travel cost, time spent, favourite fish, willingness to pay for delivery, preferred delivery time and biggest problem with buying fish.

4. First Customer Target

20 first-time customers → 10 repeat customers → 50 active customers → 100+ active customers. Do not count followers or phone numbers as customers. A customer is someone who actually orders.

5. Hotel / Delivery-Worker Referral Idea

The existing hotel-delivery connection can be useful, but do not collect customer phone numbers and send unsolicited WhatsApp messages. Use a permission-based referral system: **partner → QR/referral card → customer voluntarily contacts FISHKO → WhatsApp → today's fish → website → order.**

6. FISHKO Customer Funnel

1	Local awareness	Neighbours, referrals, hotel/community partners
2	WhatsApp / QR	Customer chooses to contact FISHKO
3	Today's fish	Show fish, price, cut options and delivery slot
4	Website	Simple order page
5	Order	Fish + quantity + cut + delivery slot
6	Processing	Clean, pack and label
7	Delivery	Batch nearby orders into morning routes
8	Feedback	Quality, price, delivery and experience
9	Repeat	Relevant future availability
10	Referral	Happy customers bring new customers

7. WhatsApp Strategy

WhatsApp should be the first major communication channel. Avoid generic spam. Record each customer's favourite fish, average order value, purchase frequency and preferred delivery time so messages can be relevant.

8. Website Role

The website is the conversion point, not the main marketing channel: **WhatsApp / Instagram / QR → Today's Fish → Price → Quantity → Cut Preference → Delivery Slot → Order**. The order process should be simple enough to complete in about one minute.

9. ■100 Product Strategy

Use ■100 as an **entry product**, not the foundation of the economics. Move regular customers toward ■200 standard orders and ■300–■500 family orders. First-order promotions should be controlled, such as limited discount or free delivery within a small radius.

10. Delivery Economics

Avoid unlimited on-demand delivery at the beginning. Create morning slots and batch nearby orders, for example 8:00–8:30, 8:30–9:00 and 9:00–9:30. Several nearby orders on one route can reduce delivery cost per order.

11. KPI Priority

Priority	Metric	Why
1	Repeat customers	Proves the product solves a real problem
2	Orders/customer/month	Measures habit
3	Average order value	Determines route economics
4	Contribution/order	Money available for marketing, staff and profit
5	Customer acquisition cost	Measures marketing efficiency
6	Delivery cost/order	Controls route economics
7	Complaints/refunds	Measures trust and quality
8	Total customers	Useful, but less important than repeat behaviour

12. Marketing Sequence

Level 1 — Free: family, neighbours, friends, existing contacts and local community groups.

Level 2 — Low cost: referral partners, QR cards, permitted local promotion and referral rewards.

Level 3 — Paid: Instagram/Facebook local advertising only after repeat-order economics are proven.

13. Customer Acquisition Cost

If ■1,000 produces 20 first-time customers, acquisition cost is ■50 per customer. That number is not enough by itself: measure **cost per repeat customer**. A customer who orders four times is much more valuable than someone who orders once.

14. Staffing Plan

Volume	Plan
Very low / Stage 1	Owner + family cleaning/packing + per-delivery or part-time delivery
10–20 orders/day	Keep fixed staff minimal; monitor workload
20–30 orders/day consistently	Consider 1 cleaner/packer
30–50 orders/day	Consider dedicated delivery + cleaner/packer
50+ orders/day	Add procurement, packing or customer-service capacity as economics justify

15. Cost Structure

Variable: fish, ice, packaging, cleaning, delivery, payment fees and wastage. **Fixed:** website/domain, salaries, equipment, phone/internet and recurring marketing. Keep these separate so break-even and profit can be calculated correctly.

16. Compliance

Because FISHKO handles and sells food, the appropriate food-business registration/licence and local requirements should be confirmed before substantial expansion. The exact FSSAI category depends on the activities and scale, so fish retail, cleaning/processing, packing and delivery should be checked before scaling.

17. What Stage 2 Should NOT Do

- Do not buy customer phone numbers or send unsolicited WhatsApp messages.
- Do not run large Meta campaigns immediately.
- Do not put stickers everywhere without permission.
- Do not promise unlimited delivery times.
- Do not deliver very small orders over a large radius.
- Do not hire several employees before workload requires them.
- Do not expand the delivery area before the local route is profitable.
- Do not use huge discounts to manufacture demand.

18. Stage 2 Success Formula

Local Awareness → WhatsApp / QR / Referral → Today's Fish → Website → Order → Clean & Pack → Batch Delivery → Feedback → Repeat Order → Referral → Regular Customer → Scale.

FISHKO is not only selling fish. The customer proposition is: **give the customer their morning time back while providing fresh fish, fair pricing, hygienic handling and reliable delivery.**

Critical next number: contribution per order. Calculate what remains after fish, cleaning, ice, packaging, delivery and wastage. That number determines how much FISHKO can afford to spend on marketing and staff.